

D.K.T.E. SOCIETY'S TEXTILE AND ENGINEERING INSTITUTE, ICHALKARANJI

Department of Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML)

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT PROJECT

Digital Empowerment

A Field Visit Report — Ichalkaranji, Maharashtra

As part of our Community Engagement Project, our team visited Ichalkaranji to understand the level of digital awareness among residents. We interacted with students, farmers, shopkeepers, women and senior citizens, and conducted an on-ground awareness session on smartphone safety, cyber security, digital payments, fake news and Artificial Intelligence.

Guided by Prof. Rekha Kamble | Academic Year 2026–2027

OUR TEAM

Group Members

Community Engagement Project — Digital Empowerment

Project Guide

Prof. Rekha Kamble



Madhur Bhandari

Roll No: 25UAM116

TEAM MEMBER



Harshvardhan Patil

Roll No: 25UAM113

TEAM MEMBER



Shreyas More

Roll No: 25UAM071

TEAM MEMBER



Siddharth Bhosale

Roll No: 25UAM072

TEAM MEMBER

LOCATION & PURPOSE

Where We Went, and Why

- Visited Ichalkaranji, Maharashtra as part of the Community Engagement Project
- Sought permission from local/municipal authorities before beginning our activities
- Goal: understand how aware residents are of digital tools, online safety and AI



Old Municipal Building, Ichalkaranji — starting point of our visit

Talking to People of All Ages

- Interacted with students, farmers, shopkeepers, women and senior citizens
- Explained the purpose of our visit and built trust before starting the survey
- Asked simple questions on smartphone use, UPI payments and cyber safety



Team with a local resident during our neighbourhood walkthrough

MARKET AWARENESS DRIVE

Engaging Local Vendors

- Spoke with vendors at the local vegetable market about digital payments
- Demonstrated how to verify a QR code before accepting UPI payments
- Answered questions about OTP fraud and suspicious payment requests



Discussing digital payments with a vegetable vendor

SHOPKEEPER INTERACTION

Cyber Safety for Small Businesses

- Guided shopkeepers on never sharing OTPs, passwords or UPI PINs
- Recommended strong passwords and two-factor authentication
- Discussed safe practices for accepting digital payments in daily business



Explaining cyber security precautions at a neighbourhood grocery store

DIGITAL PAYMENTS

Safer UPI, Every Transaction

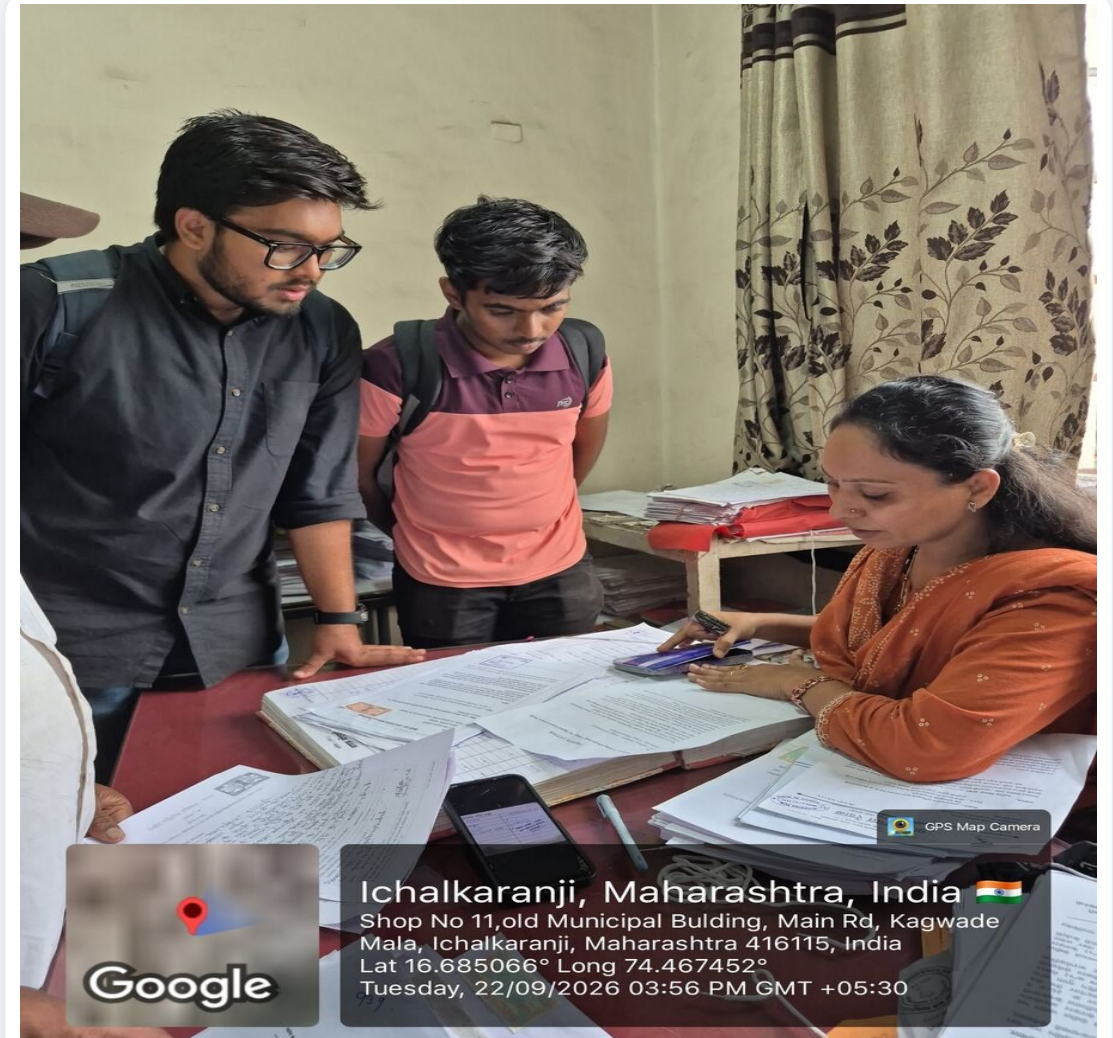
- Explained how to identify fake payment-confirmation messages
- Encouraged regularly updating banking and payment applications
- Shared steps to report suspicious activity to the bank or cyber cell



Awareness session with a flower vendor on safe digital payments

Helping with Digital Services

- Helped residents understand government digital service procedures
- Clarified doubts around online forms, records and applications
- Encouraged residents to use verified official portals only



Assisting with document-related and government service queries

SENIOR CITIZEN OUTREACH

Taking Awareness Home

- Visited homes to reach residents who could not attend the market session
- Used simple, everyday language and examples suited to senior citizens
- Encouraged every participant to pass on what they learned to their family



A home visit to explain digital safety to a senior citizen

Topics We Covered

We explained each topic in simple language, using examples from daily life.

1

Digital Literacy

Why digital skills matter today

2

Safe Smartphone Use

Everyday do's and don'ts

3

Cyber Security

Precautions against common threats

4

Online Fraud Protection

Spotting scams before they happen

5

Strong Passwords

Building better login habits

6

Safe UPI & Payments

Verifying before you pay

7

Spotting Fake News

Checking before forwarding

8

Intro to AI

Simple, everyday AI examples

WRAPPING UP

Conclusion

The Digital Empowerment project was a valuable learning experience for our team. Through our offline field visit to Ichalkaranji, we understood the real challenges rural and semi-urban communities face around digital technology, and practiced explaining technical ideas in a simple, relatable way.

- ✓ Many residents own smartphones but need guidance on safe, confident use
- ✓ Regular digital-literacy and cyber-security drives can close this gap
- ✓ Simple, example-based teaching works best across all age groups
- ✓ Villagers welcomed the session and asked for more such programs

OUR TEAM REACHED

5

Age groups engaged — students to senior citizens

8

Key digital-safety topics covered

1

Village community visited in Ichalkaranji

Thank You

Digital Empowerment • Community Engagement Project

Madhur Bhandari • Harshvardhan Patil • Shreyas More • Siddharth Bhosale

Guided by Prof. Rekha Kamble | Dept. of CSE (AI & ML), D.K.T.E. Society's TEI, Ichalkaranji

